Next, follow the steps to ensure a successful deployment to Vercel. Pay attention to the following.

PREDEPLOYMENT CONFIGURATION

This section outlines key steps for a successful deployment to Vercel. While these steps are specific to the Vercel platform, it's crucial to note certain practices, such as ensuring successful local builds and providing necessary environment variables:

- *Create a new Vercel project and add environment variables.* On the Vercel dashboard, create a new, empty project to house your application. Add all necessary environment variables to the project settings on Vercel, as in figure 9.7. This ensures that your application has access to the required configuration during deployment and run time.

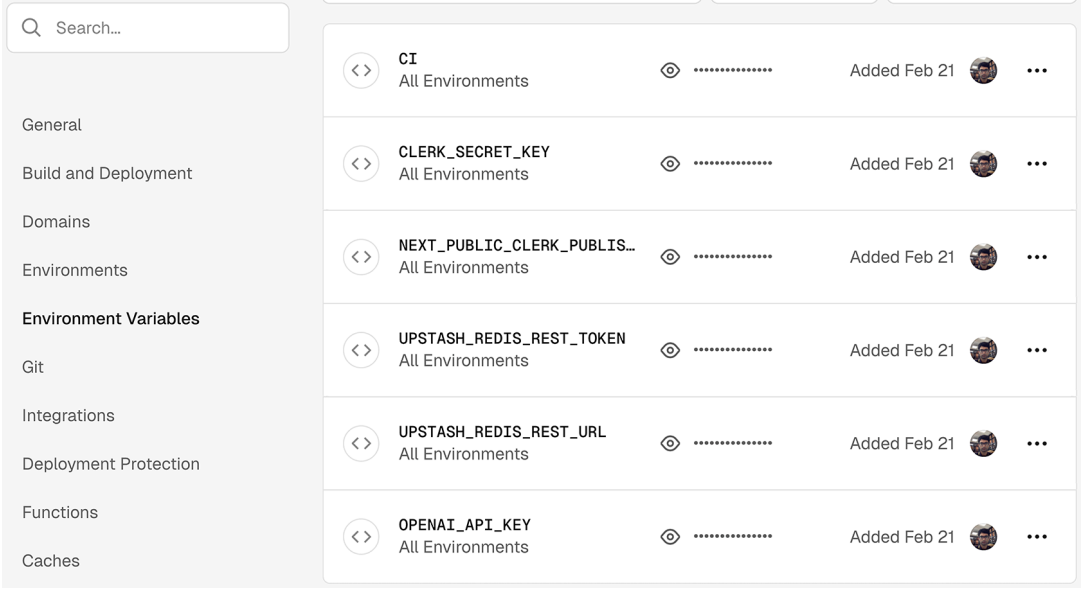


Figure 9.7 Configuration interface for project environment variables on the Vercel dashboard, displaying several masked API keys and authentication tokens

- *Ensure correct Node version.* Vercel supports specific Node.js versions, and using a compatible version is crucial for a successful deployment. Before deploying, check the Node.js version your project requires in the Build and Deployment options section of the project settings, shown in figure 9.8.
- *Verify local build success.* Before deploying to Vercel, ensure that your `npm run build` command executes successfully in your local environment. If that command fails locally, the deployment to Vercel will also fail.